

“optimized” path left me with a lot of regrets. Focusing on how great FIRE would be made it difficult for me to enjoy the amazing life I already had.

Brandon discussed his own struggles with Brad and Jonathan on the *ChooseFI* podcast. Listening to Brandon describe his own journey and feelings of unhappiness on his path to FI was very powerful. He said, “I was so hyper-focused on reaching financial independence, nothing else mattered.” He couldn’t have fun. He analyzed every dollar he spent and thought about how much money he could be saving and how it could allow him to retire sooner. In the process, he isolated himself for about two years.

Brandon’s mindset affected his wife as well. She moved to the United States from her native country of Scotland to be with him. He said, “Here she is in a foreign country and . . . all her husband wants to do is read tax documents.” Brandon didn’t see how bad things became until she told him she thought he was depressed and pointed out that neither of them was happy. He quickly decided to make changes. He couldn’t put off happiness until he was FI. The things most important to him could be lost by then if he didn’t change. They decided to move to Scotland to be closer to her family and started doing things with their friends and family again.